the eyes of United supporters, we really had achieved something. Gary, Phil, Nicky, Scholesy and myself all had the first medals of a professional career to prove it. I went off on vacation to Sardinia and, to be honest, forgot all about soccer for a couple of weeks. There wasn't a television in the bedroom and so I didn't even see most of the Euro 96 tournament that everybody was glued to back home. I just swam, lay in the sun and ate pasta until it was coming out of my ears.

If any manager is going to make sure players don't get distracted by dwelling on the past, it's Alex Ferguson. We were back for training in what seemed like no time. And, all of a sudden, a new season was about to get underway. It was at Selhurst Park in 1996. We were playing Wimbledon and there was a real sense of anticipation in the dressing room and around the ground, which was absolutely packed with United supporters. Before the game, I was getting grief in the dressing room about my new boots. Over the summer, my sponsors adidas had sent me a pair of Predator boots for the first time, but unfortunately this particular pair had been made for Charlie Miller, a young Scottish player at Glasgow Rangers. The word 'Charlie' was stitched on the tongues of the boots and the other players spotted that straight away.

Once the game kicked off, it soon felt like we were picking up where we'd left off the previous May. The team played really well and the game was as good as over by half-time. Eric Cantona was substituted, so he was sitting, watching on the bench. Jordi Cruyff tried to chip the Wimbledon keeper, Neil Sullivan, from outside the box. And I'm sure I heard someone say that, if the shot had been on target, Jordi might have scored. A couple of minutes after that, Brian McClair rolled the ball in front of me just inside our own half, and I thought: why not? *Shoot*. I hit it and I remember looking up at the ball, which seemed to be heading out towards somewhere between the goal and the corner flag. The swerve I'd put on the shot, though, started to bring it back in and the thought flashed through my mind. *This has got a chance here*.

The ball was in the air for what seemed like ages, sailing towards the goal, before it dropped over Sullivan and into the net. The next moment, Brian McClair was jumping all over me. He'd been standing there, almost beside me, and along with everybody else in the ground had just watched the ball drift downfield.

Back in the dressing room after the game, someone told me what the manager had growled when I shot:

'What does he think he's trying now?'